

Sufism and Other Mystic Philosophy in Bangladesh

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Abstract: Sufism (*tasawwuf*) deals mainly with mental, spiritual and philosophical aspects of Islam, the essence of which is to establish a direct relationship with Allah by purifying the soul. Some believe that the word *Sufi* is derived from *suf* (*wool*) and refers to the rough woolen clothing worn by early ascetics. Some other opinions are that it derives from *safa* (*purity*), from *saf* (*row*), or from *ashab-i-safa* (*row of holy persons*). The origin of Sufism is Holy Quran and Hadith (*sunna*). Literally simple life, maintaining the purity of mind-body-soul is the sign of a Sufi. As a theory, Sufism is a mystical type of philosophy in Islam. Islam is the inner exploration for enlightenment belongs to an ambit of Sufi realization. In the religion of Hindu, Buddha, Judaic, Christianity and Islam mysticism is explained in different ways, but all religions aspire for closer union with God. Bangladesh is a fertile land of various mystic philosophy of different religions. The mystic philosophy of other religions is called Sufism in Islam. Ferdoushi, Omar Khayyam, Rumi, Sheikh Shadi and Jami all are the most valuable property of Persian literature. The advent of Sufism in Bengal may be dated to the mid-eleventh or, early-twelfth century with the arrival of Muslim and Sufi preachers to this country. Borendra, Rado, Banga and Chattrala are prominent as Sufi expediting Centre. In Bengal, in the one hand, Baul, Boishnova, Lalon, Shaii established their Centre, on the other hand Sufism spreaded over there as Islamic mysticism. A comparative study would be done in this article among the similar types of mystic philosophies, where the aim is same but name and ways are different.

Key words: Sufism, Islam, Mysticism, Religion, Philosophy in Bangladesh.